

A high-magnification histological micrograph of stratified squamous epithelium, likely from the skin. The image shows multiple layers of cells. The superficial layers consist of flattened, squamous cells. The deeper layers contain more rounded, polygonal cells. The nuclei are stained dark purple, and the cytoplasm and extracellular matrix are stained pink. The overall structure is dense and organized into distinct layers.

Tissues I

BIOL2251

Chapter 4

Sections 4.1 – 4.6

Tissue Type Sorting



Tissue Type Sorting

- **Instructions**

- Work on your own (3 min)
 - **Write down everything you remember about each of the four major tissue types**
- Form small groups (4-6 people)
 - **Share your lists and create one comprehensive group list**
- Quick show of thumbs (up = confident in all four, sideways = mostly there, down = need more review)
- **Bloom's taxonomy = Remember**

Tissue Type Sorting

- **Epithelial:** Covers/lines body surfaces, protection, secretion, absorption, little extracellular matrix, avascular, high regeneration
- **Connective:** Support, connect/anchor, protection, diverse matrix, usually vascularized, cells spread apart
- **Muscle:** Movement, contraction, excitable cells, striated or smooth
- **Nervous:** Communication, impulse transmission, neurons and support cells, excitable



Epithelial Cell Orientation

Epithelial Cell Orientation

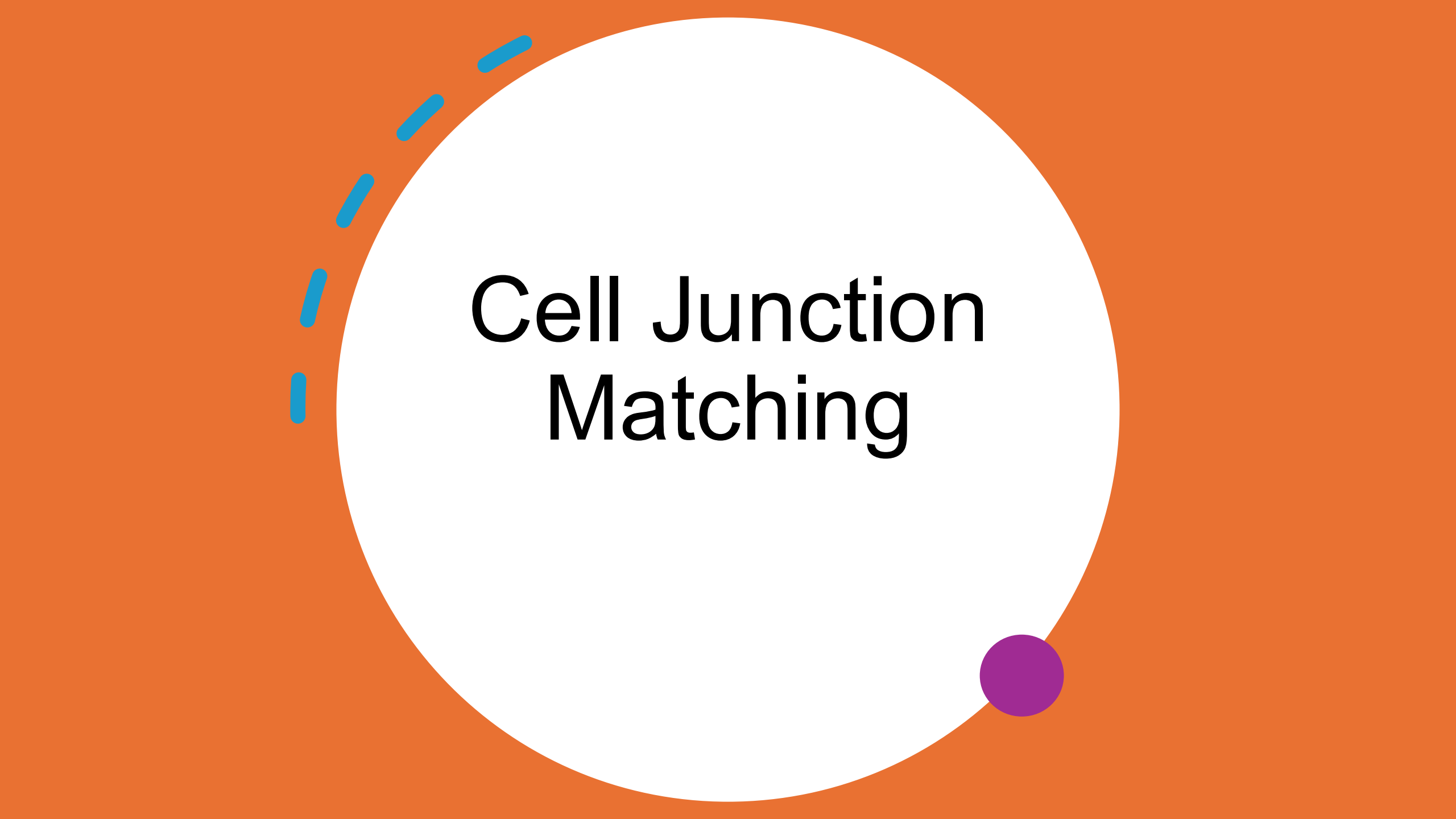
- **Instructions**

- Think: **Make a basic diagram of an epithelial cell**
 - **Label: apical surface, basolateral surface, basement membrane. Add at least 2 specializations that might be found on the apical surface**
- Pair: Compare labels with partner
 - **Why does the apical surface face "free space"?**
 - **What's in the basement membrane and why is it important?**
- Share: I will call on pairs to share one key function of surface orientation

- **Bloom's taxonomy = Understand, Analyze**

Epithelial Cell Orientation

- **Apical surface:** Faces lumen/external environment; may have microvilli (absorption), cilia (movement), or glycocalyx (protection)
- **Basolateral surface:** Faces other cells (lateral) and basement membrane (basal); contains cell junctions
- **Basement membrane:** Composed of basal lamina (collagen + glycoproteins from epithelium) and reticular lamina (from connective tissue); anchors epithelium, selective barrier, scaffolding for regeneration
- **Why orientation matters:** Directional transport (absorption/secretion), protection from one side, coordinated function



Cell Junction Matching

Cell Junction Matching

- **Instructions**

- I will give project a list of cell junction types, functions, and real-life analogies
 - **Working in small groups, match the junction type to its function and the analogy**
 - Debrief: Whole class - when might you want each type?
- **Bloom's taxonomy = Remember, Understand**

Cell Junction Matching

Junction Type	Function	Analogy
Tight Junction	Anchor cells together to resist mechanical stress	Zipper / Seal
Gap Junction	Allow ions and small molecules to pass directly between cells	Tunnel / Straw
Desmosomes	Prevent passage of water and solutes between cells	Rivet / Button snap

Tight junctions → Prevent passage of water and solutes → **Like a zipper/seal**

Gap junctions → Allow ions/small molecules to pass directly between cells → **Like a tunnel/straw**

Desmosomes → Anchor cells together to resist mechanical stress → **Like a rivet/button snap**

A decorative graphic on the left side of the slide. It features a solid blue circle at the bottom left. Above it, a dashed blue arc curves upwards and to the right. The background is split: the top-left corner is orange, and the rest is white, separated by a curved line that follows the arc of the dashed line.

Epithelial Classification Matrix

Epithelial Classification Matrix

- **Instructions**

- Work in groups at your table
- **Make a grid with cell shapes (squamous, cuboidal, columnar) on one side and layering (simple, stratified) on the other**
 - **For each combination, provide an example function and location**
- Check your board by comparing with another group
- Whole class discussion: **Which combinations are most common and why?**
- **Bloom's taxonomy = Understand, Analyze**

Epithelial Classification Matrix

	Simple	Stratified
Squamous	Diffusion, filtration (lungs, blood vessels)	Protection from abrasion (skin, esophagus)
Cuboidal	Secretion, absorption (kidney tubules, glands)	Protection, secretion, absorption (rare – lining some ducts)
Columnar	Absorption, secretion (intestines, stomach)	Protection (male urethra, large ducts)

Epithelial Tissue Matching Tournament



Epithelial Tissue Matching Tournament

- **Instructions**

- Work in small groups – **this is a competition!**
- **You will receive a list of 6 tissues and 12 scrambled statements**
 - **Match each tissue to 2 statements (1 location, 1 function)**
- First group to finish holds up paper – all groups stop
- I will check the answers before you claim your prize
- We will review correct answers as class
- **Bloom's taxonomy = Remember, Apply**

Epithelial Tissue Matching Tournament

Tissues	Locations	Functions
Simple Squamous	A. Lines most of the digestive tract	G. Stretches to accommodate volume changes
Simple Cuboidal	B. Forms air sacs of lungs	H. Diffusion and filtration
Simple Columnar	C. Lines the bladder	I. Protection from physical abrasion
Stratified Squamous	D. Lines the trachea	J. Absorption and secretion of mucus
Transitional	E. Forms outer layer of skin	K. Secretion and absorption
Pseudostratified Columnar	F. Forms kidney tubules	L. Moves mucus via cilia

Epithelial Tissue Matching Tournament

- **Simple squamous:** B (air sacs/lungs), H (diffusion and filtration)
- **Simple cuboidal:** F (kidney tubules), K (secretion and absorption)
- **Simple columnar:** A (digestive tract), J (absorption and secretion of mucus)
- **Stratified squamous:** E (skin), I (protection from physical abrasion)
- **Transitional:** C (bladder), G (stretches to accommodate volume)
- **Pseudostratified columnar:** D (trachea), L (moves mucus via cilia)

Gland Type Comparison



Gland Type Comparison

- **Instructions**

- Think: **Draw a chart comparing exocrine and endocrine glands**
 - **Include: structure, secretion destination, examples**
- Pair: Compare with partner, refine your diagram, generate 3 examples of each type
- Share: Whole class discussion

- **Bloom's taxonomy = Understand, Analyze**

Gland Type Comparison

Exocrine Glands:

- Have ducts that carry secretions
- Secrete onto surfaces or into cavities
- Products: mucus, sweat, oil, digestive enzymes, milk
- Examples: sweat glands, salivary glands, pancreas (exocrine portion), mammary glands

Endocrine Glands:

- Ductless
- Secrete hormones into bloodstream/extracellular fluid
- Products travel via blood to distant targets
- Examples: thyroid, pituitary, adrenal, pancreas (endocrine portion - islets)

Both:

Derived from epithelial tissue

Secretory function

Can be part of same organ (pancreas)



Connective Tissue Proper – Matrix Madness

CT Proper – Matrix Madness

- **Instructions**

- Work in small groups
- Answer the following questions:
 - **What are the two main components of connective tissue proper matrix?**
 - **Ground substance: what is it made of and what does it do?**
 - **Fibers: what are the three types and what's special about each?**
 - **How does matrix composition differ between loose and dense CT?**
- Completion check: Thumbs vote on confidence understanding matrix
- **Bloom's taxonomy = Understand, Analyze**

CT Proper – Matrix Madness

Matrix Components:

- **Ground substance:** Gel-like material between cells and fibers
 - Proteoglycans, glycoproteins, water
 - Functions: holds tissue fluid, medium for nutrient/waste diffusion, resists compression
- **Fibers:** Protein structures providing strength
 - **Collagen:** Strong, rope-like, resists tension (most abundant)
 - **Elastic:** Stretchy, allows recoil after stretching
 - **Reticular:** Fine, branching, forms supportive networks

Loose vs Dense CT:

- **Loose:** More ground substance, fewer/looser fibers, more cells, more space
- **Dense:** Less ground substance, tightly packed fibers, fewer cells, less space

Connective Tissue Proper Mini Cases



Connective Tissue Proper Mini Cases

- **Instructions**

- Work in small groups
- You will be given 4 scenarios
- For each scenario, **identify the type of connective tissue proper** and explain:
 - **Which tissue is involved?**
 - **What structural features make it suited for this role?**
 - **Where in the body would you find this tissue?**
- Each group shares on scenario until all 4 scenarios have been review
- **Bloom's taxonomy = Apply, Analyze, Evaluate**

Connective Tissue Proper Mini Cases

Scenario 1: A patient receives a deep cut that reaches below the skin. The wound is packed with a soft, gel-like tissue that contains many white blood cells fighting infection. This tissue also wraps around blood vessels supplying the area.

- **Answer:** Areolar CT - loose, gel-like matrix, holds tissue fluid, contains wandering immune cells (WBCs), wraps organs/vessels, found under epithelia

Scenario 2: During a kidney transplant, surgeons note a delicate mesh-like framework supporting the internal structure of lymph nodes they must navigate around.

- **Answer:** Reticular CT - fine reticular fibers form 3D network, supports lymphoid organs (spleen, lymph nodes, bone marrow), traps cells in framework

Connective Tissue Proper Mini Cases

Scenario 3: A person training for a marathon stores energy reserves that provide insulation and cushion vital organs. This tissue also produces hormones that regulate metabolism.

- **Answer:** Adipose tissue - adipocytes store triglycerides, insulation, protection, energy reserve, endocrine function (leptin), found under skin, around organs

Scenario 4: An athlete tears their Achilles tendon, which normally connects calf muscle to heel bone. The tissue is white, tough, and has fibers all running in the same direction.

- **Answer:** Dense regular CT - parallel collagen fibers, withstands tension in one direction, tendons (muscle to bone) and ligaments (bone to bone), white/shiny appearance

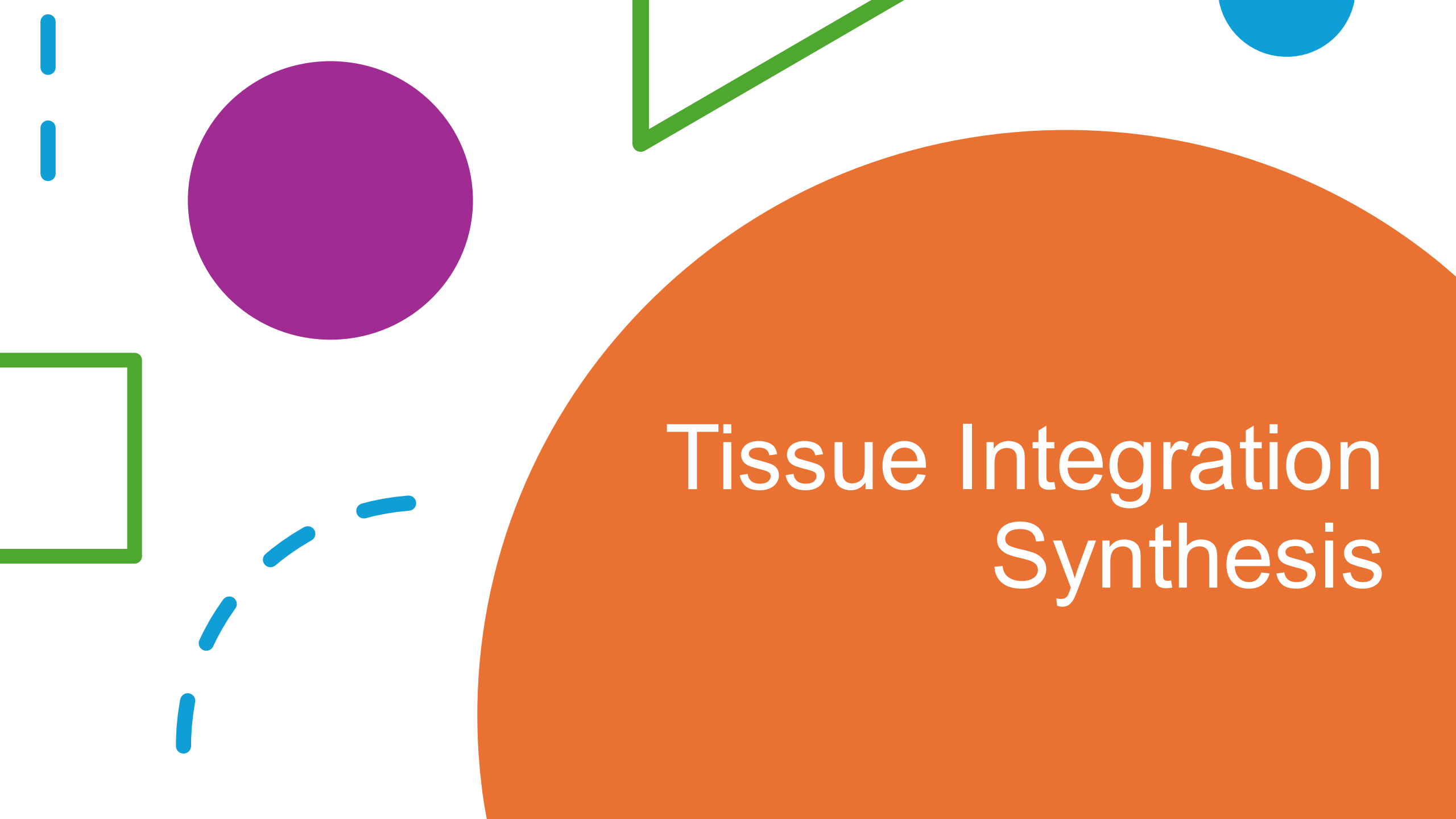
Connective Tissue Proper Mini Cases

Scenario 5: A leather craftsman works with animal skin (dermis), noting its toughness and ability to withstand stress from multiple directions. The tissue forms a strong, irregularly arranged layer.

- **Answer:** Dense irregular CT - collagen fibers in multiple directions, withstands tension from various angles, dermis of skin, organ capsules, joint capsules

Scenario 6: An infant has difficulty maintaining body temperature because they lack sufficient tissue for insulation underneath their skin.

- **Answer:** Adipose tissue - infants have less subcutaneous fat, develops more with age, brown fat in infants for heat generation



Tissue Integration Synthesis

Tissue Integration Synthesis

- **Instructions**

- Work in small groups
- Each group will be given an organ, for which you will need to list the following:
 - Which epithelial tissue(s) line it and why?
 - Which connective tissue(s) support it and why?
 - What cell junctions would be important and why?
- We will share and discuss as a class
- **Bloom's taxonomy = Analyze, Evaluate**

Tissue Integration Synthesis

EXAMPLE 1: Small Intestine

- **Epithelial tissue:**
 - Simple columnar with microvilli and goblet cells
 - Single layer for efficient absorption; microvilli increase surface area
- **Connective tissues:**
 - Areolar CT (lamina propria) - holds blood/lymph vessels for nutrient absorption
 - Dense irregular CT - provides strength for movement/stretching
 - Adipose - cushions and anchors intestines
- **Cell junctions:**
 - Tight junctions - prevent leakage of enzymes/bacteria between cells
 - Desmosomes - hold tissue together during peristalsis
 - Gap junctions (in muscle) - coordinate contractions

Tissue Integration Synthesis

EXAMPLE 2: Urinary Bladder

- **Epithelial tissue:**
 - Transitional epithelium
 - Stretches from thick (empty) to thin (full); impermeable to urine
- **Connective tissues:**
 - Areolar CT - allows stretching, provides elasticity
 - Dense irregular CT - withstands pressure from multiple directions
 - Adipose - cushions bladder
- **Cell junctions:**
 - Tight junctions - prevent toxic urine from leaking into body
 - Desmosomes - hold cells together during extreme stretching
 - Gap junctions (in muscle) - coordinate bladder emptying

Tissue Integration Synthesis

EXAMPLE 3: Trachea

- **Epithelial tissue:**
 - Pseudostratified columnar ciliated with goblet cells
 - Cilia move mucus up and out; goblet cells trap debris/pathogens
- **Connective tissues:**
 - Areolar CT - vascularized to warm/humidify air; allows flexibility
 - Hyaline cartilage (C-shaped rings) - keeps airway open, prevents collapse
 - Dense irregular CT (perichondrium) - covers cartilage
- **Cell junctions:**
 - Tight junctions - prevent pathogens from penetrating tissue
 - Desmosomes - resist mechanical stress from airflow/coughing
 - Gap junctions - coordinate ciliary beating

Tissue Integration Synthesis

EXAMPLE 4: Skin

- **Epithelial tissue:**
 - Stratified squamous (keratinized)
 - Multiple layers for protection; dead surface cells waterproof and resist damage
- **Connective tissues:**
 - Areolar CT (papillary dermis) - capillaries nourish epidermis; sensory receptors
 - Dense irregular CT (reticular dermis) - collagen resists tearing from all directions
 - Adipose (hypodermis) - insulation, energy storage, cushioning
- **Cell junctions:**
 - Desmosomes - extremely abundant; resist mechanical stress and friction
 - Tight junctions - help prevent water loss
 - Gap junctions - coordinate cell communication and responses



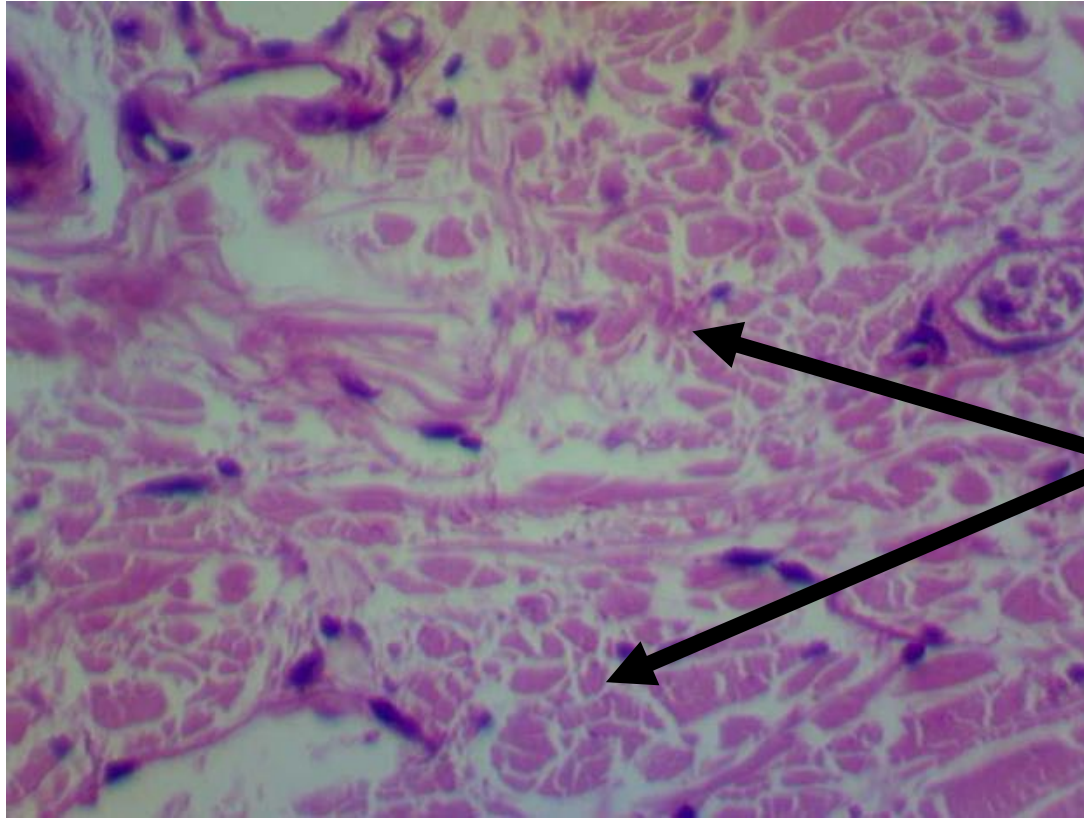
Tissue Identification

Instructions

- **Form a team (4-8 people)**
- Identify the tissue presented on the slide
 - 90 seconds to think and discuss as a team
 - Submit your answer on a notecard
 - **Correct tissue identification = 1 point**
 - **Correct function = 1 point**
 - **Correct location = 1 point**
 - **Correct function and location = 3 points**
- **Team with the most points wins!**

Question 1

Dense Irregular Tissue (Dense Connective)



No lumen!

Fibers running
in different
directions
(meshwork)

Functions

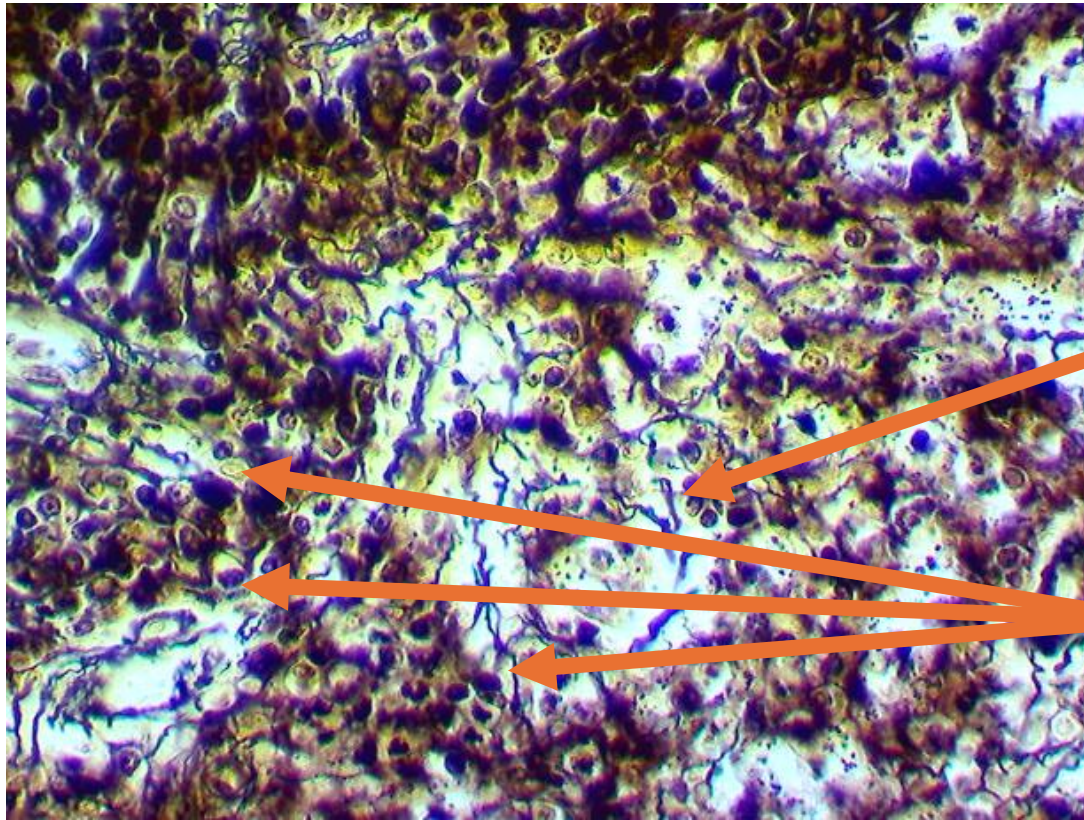
- Strength to resist forces from many directions
- Helps prevent overexpansion

Locations

- Skin
- Periosteum
- Perichondria
- Nerve and muscle sheaths
- Organ capsules

Question 2

Reticular Tissue (Loose Connective)



No lumen!

Dark,
Branching
Fibers

Lots of
similar cells

Functions

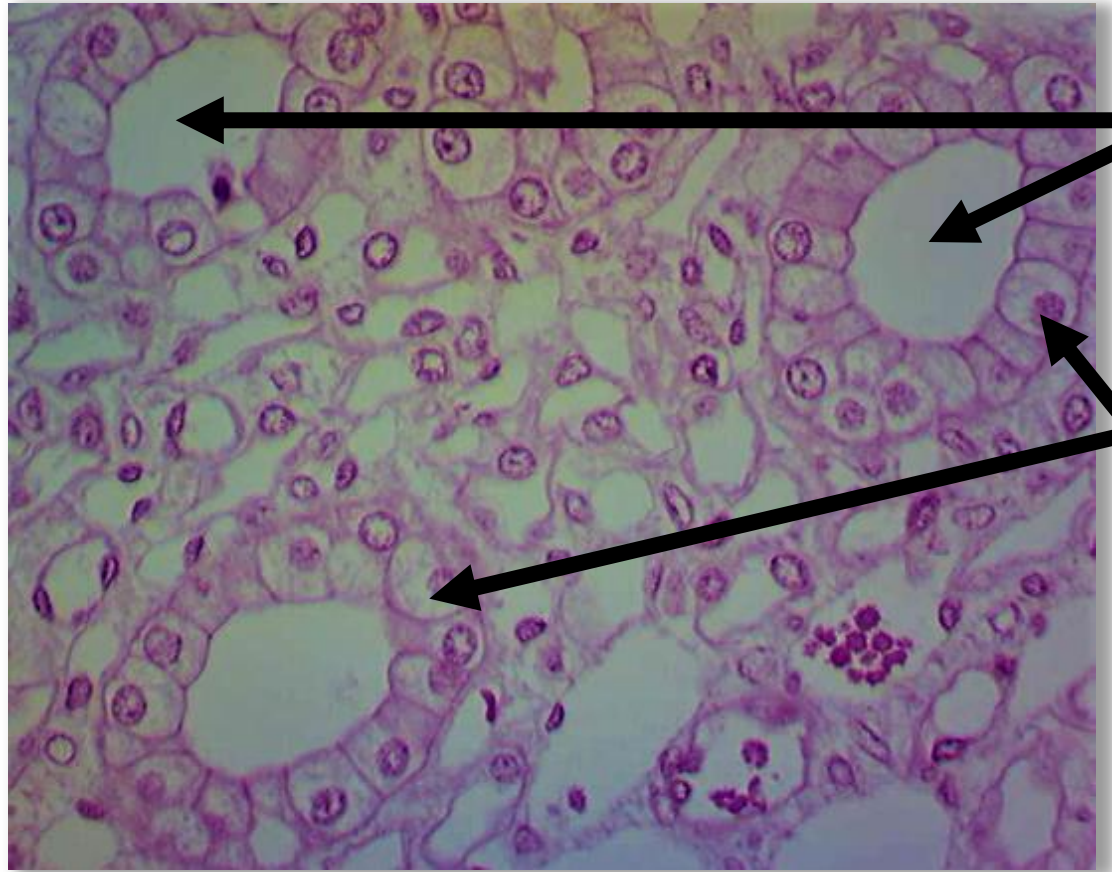
- Supporting framework

Locations

- Liver
- Kidney
- Spleen
- Lymph Nodes
- Bone Marrow

Question 3

Simple Cuboidal (Epithelial)



Lumen

Single layer of
square-shaped
cells surrounding
the lumen

Functions

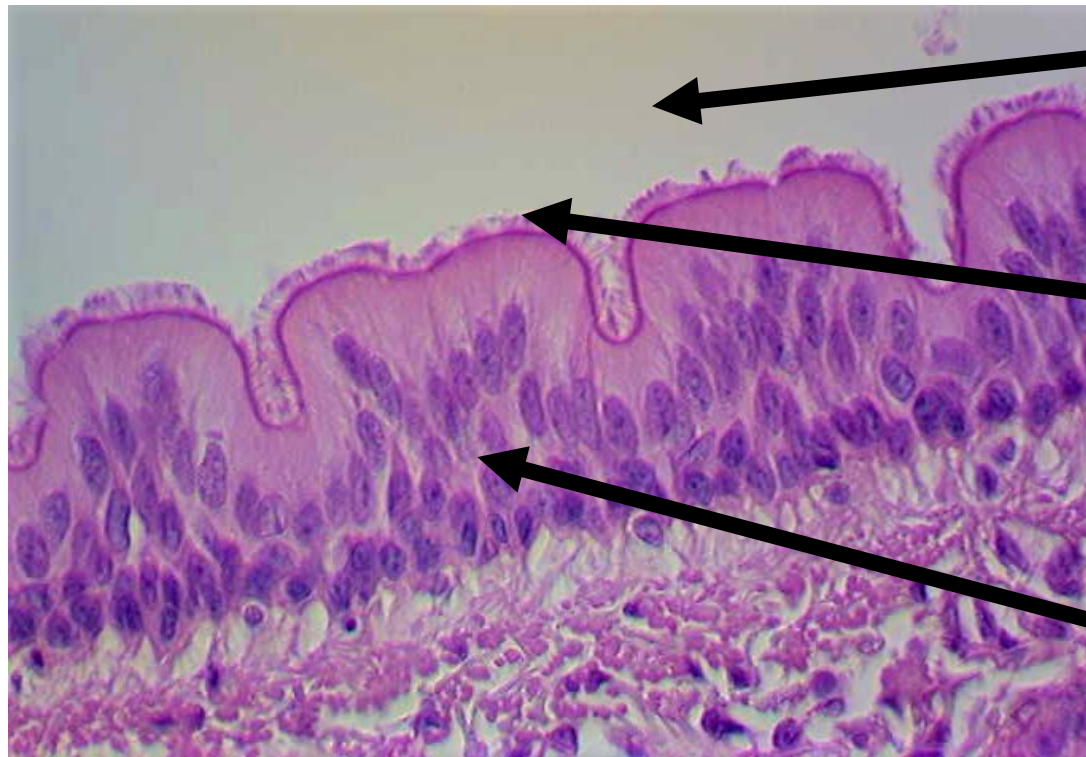
- Secretion
- Absorption

Locations

- Glands
- Ducts
- Kidneys
- Thyroid Gland

Question 4

Pseudostratified Columnar (Epithelial)



Lumen

Cilia

Tall, Skinny Cells

Nuclei look like they are on several different layers.

Functions

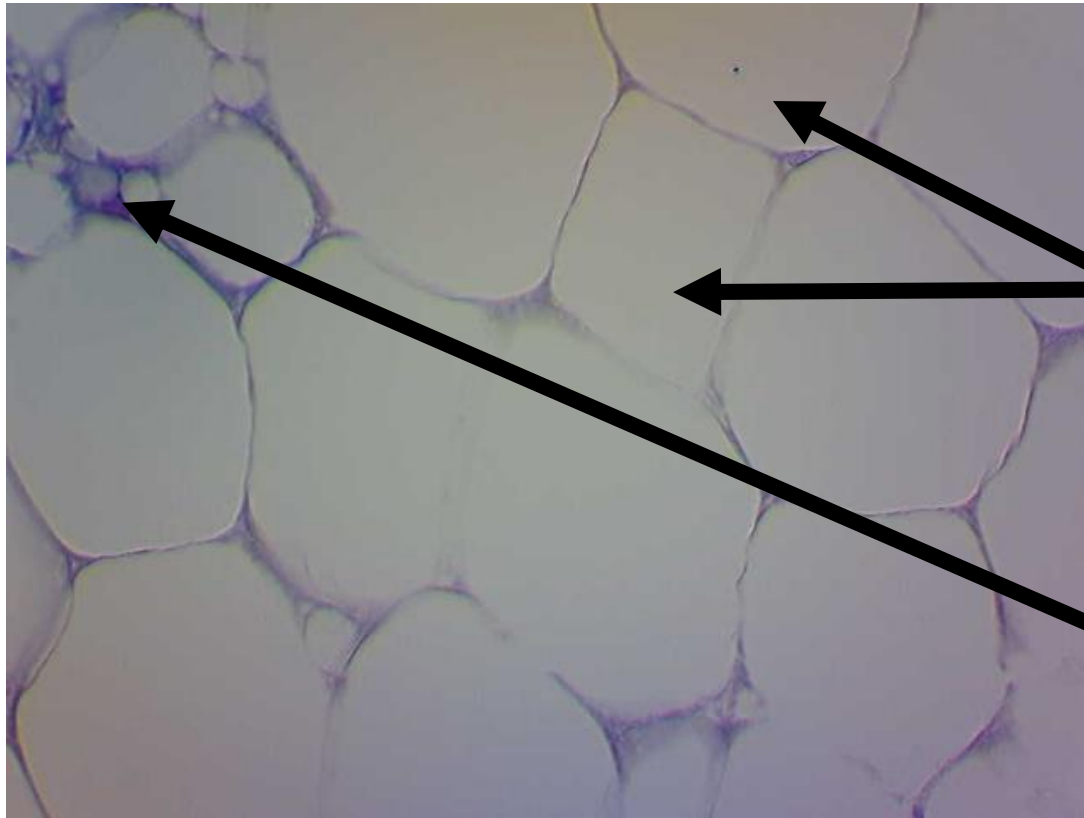
- Secretion
- Protection
- Movement of mucus by cilia

Locations

- Lining of nasal cavity
- Trachea
- Bronchi
- Portions of male reproductive tract

Question 5

Adipose Tissue (Loose Connective)



No lumen!

Large white
blobs

Not many
visible
nuclei

Functions

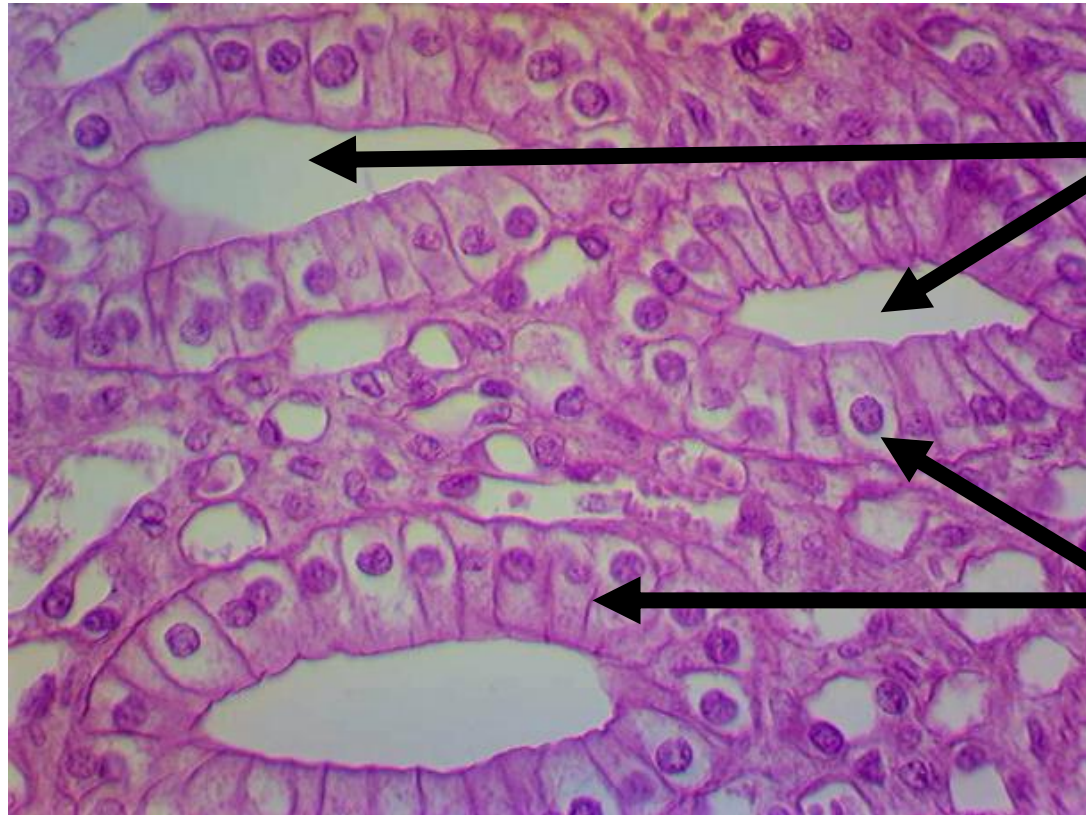
- Padding
- Cushioning
- Insulation
- Energy Storage

Locations

- Under skin
- Buttocks
- Breasts
- Padding around eyes and kidneys

Question 6

Simple Columnar (Epithelial)



Lumen

Tall, skinny
cells

Nuclei appear
to be at
roughly the
same level

Functions

- Protection
- Secretion
- Absorption

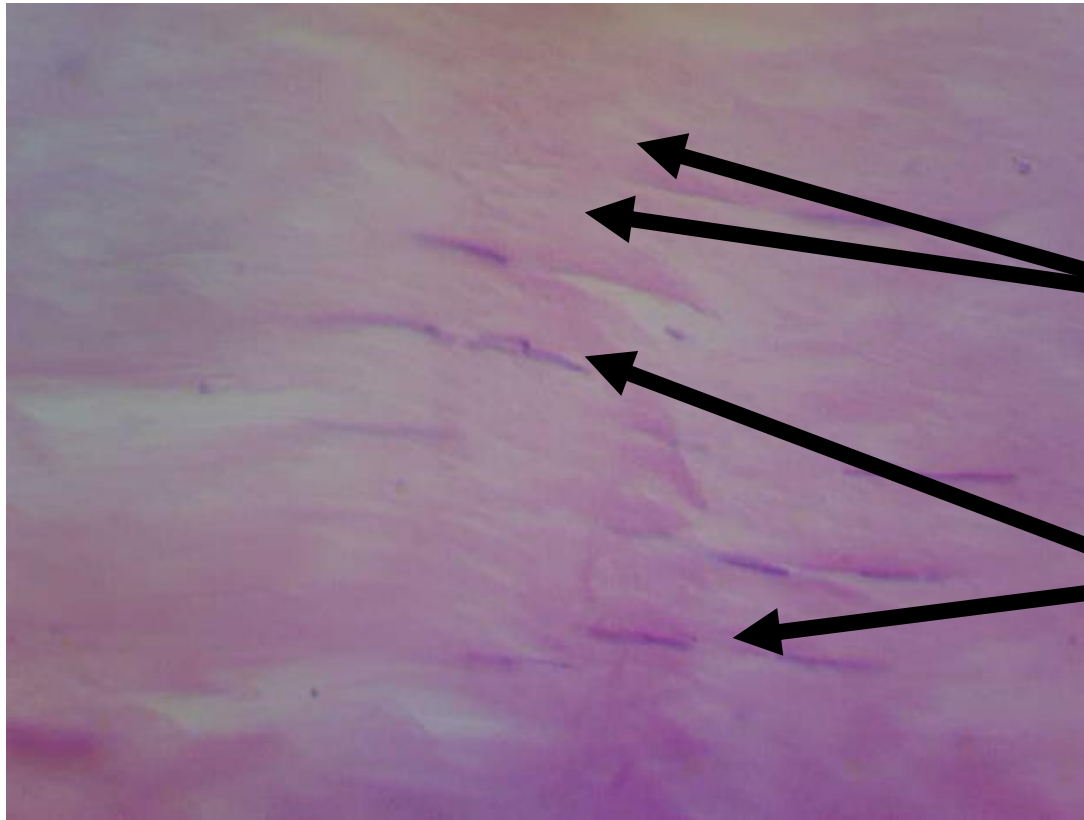
Locations

Lining of

- Stomach
- Intestines
- Gallbladder
- Uterine Tubes

Question 7

Dense Regular Tissue (Dense Connective)



No lumen!

Parallel
Fibers

Cells
(fibroblasts)
squished
between fibers

Functions

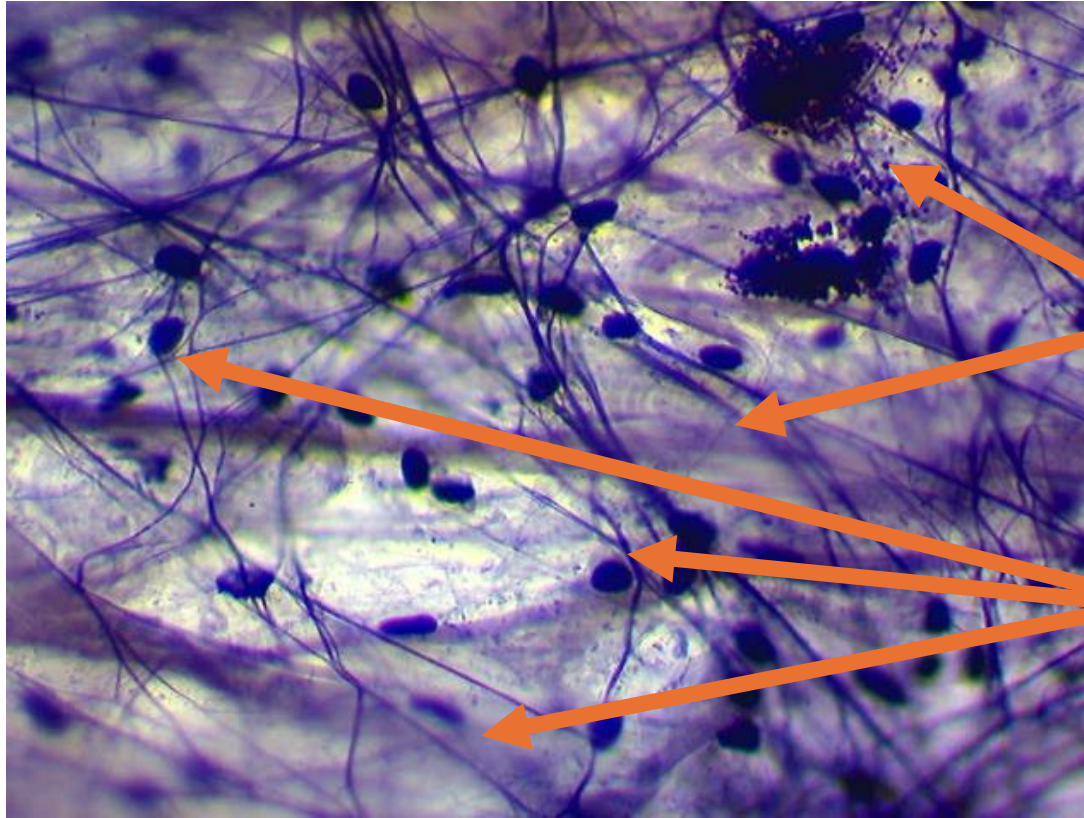
- Firm attachment
- Pull of muscles
- Reduces friction between muscles
- Stabilizes bone positions

Locations

- Tendons
- Ligaments
- Covering of skeletal muscles

Question 8

Areolar Tissue (Loose Connective)



No lumen!

Scattered
cells (many
types)

Different
fiber types

Functions

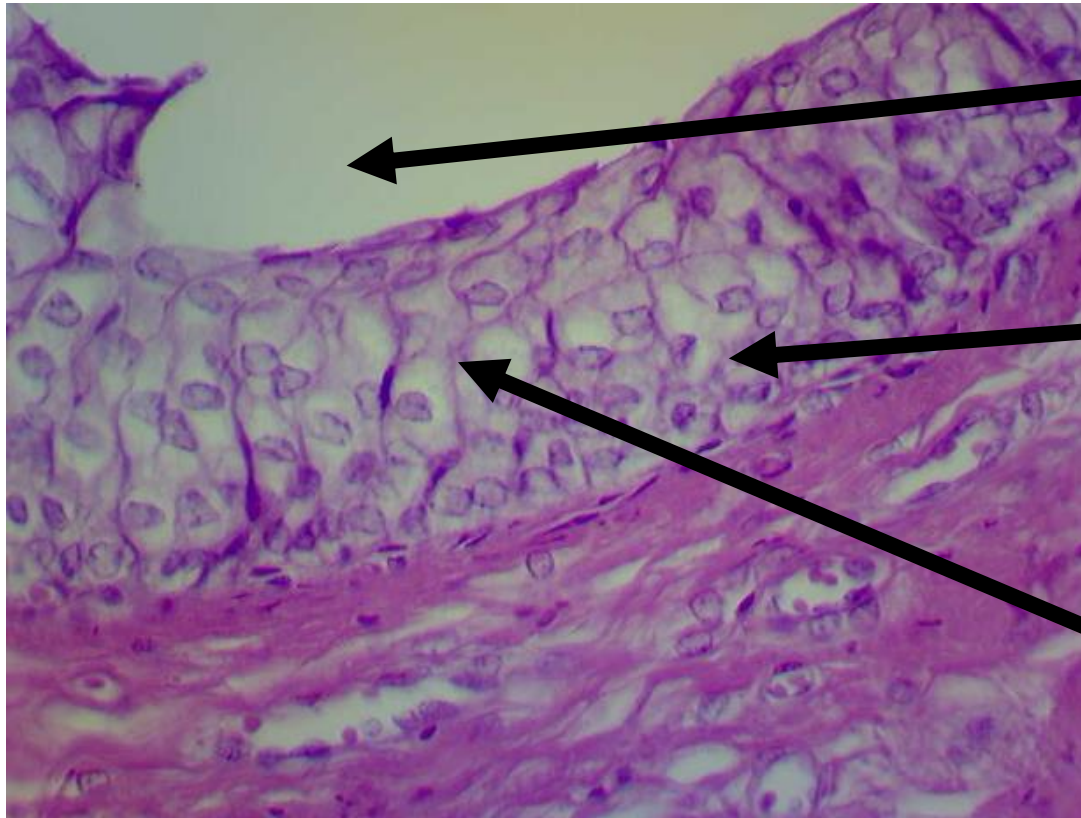
- Cushions organs
- Support with movement
- Defense (immunity)

Locations

- Underneath epithelial tissue

Question 9

Transitional Tissue (Epithelial)



Lumen

Multiple
layers

Cells next to
lumen look
like cubes (or
flattened)

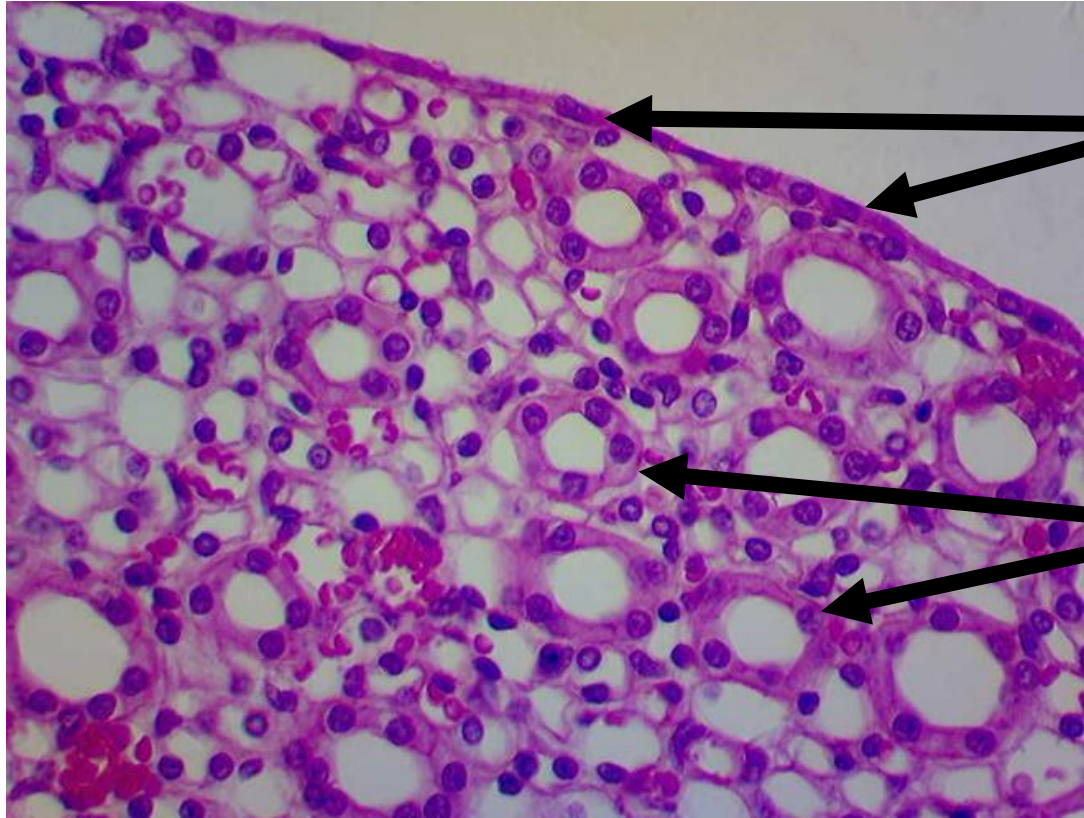
Functions

- Permits expansion and recoil (stretching)

Locations

- Bladder
- Renal pelvis
- Ureters

Question 10 (Two Tissues)



Simple Squamous

Simple Cuboidal